

Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick

Twenty-Second Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 30th August 2026

Parish Clergy

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Thoughts on the Gospel (*Matthew 16:21-27*)

The Gospel today teaches us that following Jesus is not always a journey toward comfort, popularity, or worldly success. It is a journey of surrender, sacrifice, and faithful love. Jesus showed His disciples that His mission would involve suffering and death before victory could come. Peter resisted this difficult truth because he wanted a safer path. Like Peter, we sometimes want God's blessings without life's burdens, a crown without a cross, and victory without sacrifice. Yet Jesus teaches us that the greatest profit is not found in gaining more but in becoming more like Him.

Let the word **PROFIT** guide our reflection.

True PROFIT is not having everything while losing ourselves. It is *Pursuing* God's purpose, *Rejecting* empty paths, *Offering* our lives, *Following* faithfully, *Investing* in what lasts, and *Treasuring* our souls. When we choose Christ above everything else, even our sacrifices become seeds of renewal. We may lose temporary comforts, but we gain a life filled with meaning, peace, and eternal hope.

*May the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ enlighten the eyes of our mind,
so that we can see what hope his call holds for us.*

Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio will be celebrated on Wednesday 2nd September at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio. Everyone welcome.

Feast of St Pio – Wednesday 23rd September To celebrate the feast of St Pio, a triduum of prayer will take place in the parishes of our pastoral area on days beforehand – more details next week. Mass to celebrate the feast day will take place on Wednesday 23rd September at 7 pm in St Patrick's Church, Murlog.

Eucharistic Adoration takes place on **Wednesday** from **8.30 am – 5.30 pm** in **Sacred Heart Church, Derry Rd.** Eucharistic Adoration will resume in **St Patrick's, Murlog** on **Monday 7th September** from **10.30 am – 1.00 pm.** Everyone welcome.

We wish every blessing on all the students, teachers and school staff of our parish pastoral area, as they return to school. God bless for the year ahead.

Prayer for a New School Year We thank you Lord, for all that was good during the summer. For the love of family and friends, and for the sunshine and warm days.

As we begin a new school year we ask for your help and pray your blessing on all our school communities. Show us how to work together for the good of all.

May we share our talents and abilities to the full and grow in knowledge, wisdom and happiness. Give us the grace to become more like Jesus in the ways we think and behave. During this school year, let us become builders of your ways and instruments of your peace. Be with us all as we embark on this new year. We ask this prayer through Jesus Christ, Our Lord. Amen.

Requiescat in Pace Martin Gallagher, Bingley, Yorkshire (formerly of Laurel Drive)

Anniversaries Margaret Connolly, Dympna Coyle, Edward Crawford, Wilma Dolan, John Gallagher, Philomena Gallagher, Pat Gillespie, Patrick Holland, John Kelly, Robert McClay Jnr, Mary McDaid, Anne McElhinney, Hughie McElhinney, George McGilloway, Teresa McGonagle, Anna Patton, Hannah Patton, Harry Patton, Margaret Tighe. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to recent collections:

Leckpatrick: £1,307.14 (23/8/26), £1,306.96 (9/8/26), £1,507.68 (2/8/26)

Clonleigh: €1,561.34 (23/8/26), €1,455.84 (9/8/26), €1,593.41 (2/8/26)

Camus: £1,508.47 (23/8/26), £1,727.60 (9/8/26), £1,731.47 (2/8/26)

Thanks also to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 6th September:

1st Reading: Ezekiel 33:7-9

Psalm: 95:1-2, 6-7, 8-9

2nd Reading: Romans 13:8-10

Gospel: Matthew 18:15-20

Saints of The Coming Week:

Wednesday: St Gregory the Great, pope and doctor of the Church

Thursday: St Mac Nissi, bishop

Friday: St Teresa of Calcutta, virgin

Donegal Down's Syndrome Assoc Annual Church Gate Collection this weekend at St Patrick's Murlog. Your support for this important fundraising event is greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down's syndrome and their families across Donegal.

The Season of Creation takes place from 1st September – 4th October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, 'Living Water', invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation. You are warmly invited to the streaming of **World Council of Churches online service** marking the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation on Tuesday 1st September from 1.45 – 3.00 pm at The Conference Room, Steelstown Church, Derry, BT48 8EU. For information, please contact laudatosiderry@gmail.com RSVP: 07711900420.

A Prayer for our Earth (Pope Francis, Laudato Si, 246)

(Tuesday 1st September – World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation)

All-powerful God, you are present in the whole universe and in the smallest of your creatures. You embrace with your tenderness all that exists. Pour out upon us the power of your love, that we may protect life and beauty. Fill us with peace, that we may live as brothers and sisters, harming no one. O God of the poor, help us to rescue the abandoned and forgotten of this earth, so precious in your eyes. Bring healing to our lives, that we may protect the world and not prey on it, that we may sow beauty, not pollution and destruction. Touch the hearts of those who look only for gain at the expense of the poor and the earth. Teach us to discover the worth of each thing, to be filled with awe and contemplation, to recognise that we are profoundly united with every creature as we journey towards your infinite light. We thank you for being with us each day. Encourage us, we pray, in our struggle for justice, love, and peace.

Come and See Have you heard about the Encounter School of Ministry Course but aren't sure what it's about or if it's for you? We invite you to 'Come and see' before you make your decision. Classes will take place on Thursdays from 6.30 – 9.00 pm beginning on 3rd September in All Saints Church, Newtowncunningham. First half hour is prayer and worship. Participants can attend up to 3 classes without committing to pay for the course. Application deadline: October 1st. Tuition fees will then be applied. More information or register at <https://encounterschool.org/donegal/> or email donegal@encounterschool.org for more information.

Porter School of Irish Dancing Classes resume on Monday 7th Sept at Lifford Resource Centre. Registration is now open. Classes available for 4 year olds and over. Teachers fully qualified and garda vetted. To register your interest, please call 0044 7515525499 or visit facebook page: Porter School of Irish Dance.

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles on Sun 13th Sept at 1.30 pm in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt. All welcome. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on 13th Sept at 11.30 am in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year. All welcome.

Padre Pio Prayer Group, Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty, Derry on Tuesday 1st September starting with Rosary at 6.45 pm, celebration of Mass at 7.15 pm followed by closing prayer and blessing with a first class relic of St Pio. All welcome.

Pray for Vocations That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people. Visit: <https://derryvocations.org>

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26th September at 12 noon in the Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny. Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll, Bishop Donal Mc Keown and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all guests, their families and all helpers who travelled with us over the years to our Mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Lough Derg Day Retreats August 31; September 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20 – a day of prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal. Visit www.loughderg.org All welcome.

St Joseph's Men's Camino A Day of pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal on Sat 12th Sept. Step away from the demands of everyday life and spend a day walking with Christ and other Catholic men. Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, the 25km guided pilgrimage along the beautiful Boyne Valley is open to all men aged 18+. Cost €65/€55 (incl lunch/dinner). Visit www.dominicans.ie

Coffee Morning in Aid of Foyle Hospice Join us on Friday 25th September from 9.30 am – 12.30 pm at Murphy's on the Green. Prize draw: £1 per line. All welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day: Sun 6 September at Termonbacca, Derry, beginning with the National Mass at 2.00 pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. Email info@catholicmothers.ie

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) parish. 12 hours per week. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hour. For application pack, please contact recruitment@derrydiocese.org or 028 71262302. Closing date: 12 noon on Tuesday 15th September 2026.

September Men's Rosary will take place on Saturday 5th September at 1.00 pm at Market Square, Letterkenny. Everyone welcome.

Blood Cancer Awareness Month Strabane Fundraising Branch will hold a sponsored walk on Friday 4th September at 7.00 pm starting from MK's Bar on the Derry Road. Suitable for all. Please join us.

Pope's Prayer Intention for September You are invited to answer the Holy Father's request and join many people worldwide in praying for the following intention: **For the care of water.** Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8 pm in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St. All welcome.

Reflections Through Poetry book by Fr John P Forbes available in Pastoral Office. Cost: £10. Proceeds to Children in Crossfire and Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation.

Cancer Focus NI – Pink Colour Fun Run takes place at Ebrington Square, Derry on 18th October. Details available at www.cancerfocusni.org/foyle-pink-run

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: 8.30 am (30th Aug – alternate Sundays – 13th Sept)

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: 8.30 am (6th Sept – alternate Sundays – 20th Sept)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes. **Office hours:** Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am – 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am – 12.30 pm. Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.